



VOLUME 08

SKEINSCRIPT AND PLUGIN ARCHITECTURE

SkeinScript language, compiler, VM, debugging, native bindings, plugin manifests, lifecycle, versioning and extension points.

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08.01 Language goals and grammar boundary

Purpose and boundary: syntax

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Language goals and grammar boundary, with particular attention to syntax. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Syntax is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with types is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for syntax; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep types behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LanguageGoalsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LanguageGoalsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LanguageGoalsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.01 and syntax.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.01 Language goals and grammar boundary

Architecture: types

This page defines the architecture for Language goals and grammar boundary, with particular attention to types. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Types is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with modules is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for types; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep modules behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Language", "LanguageGoalsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.01 and types.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.01 Language goals and grammar boundary

Data model: modules

This page defines the data model for Language goals and grammar boundary, with particular attention to modules. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Modules is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with small-language rule is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for modules; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep small-language rule behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LanguageGoalsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LanguageGoalsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LanguageGoalsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.01 and modules.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.01 Language goals and grammar boundary

Public API: small-language rule

This page defines the public api for Language goals and grammar boundary, with particular attention to small-language rule. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Small-language rule is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with compatibility is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for small-language rule; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep compatibility behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Language", "LanguageGoalsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.01 and small-language rule.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.01 Language goals and grammar boundary

Ownership and lifetime: compatibility

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Language goals and grammar boundary, with particular attention to compatibility. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Compatibility is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with syntax is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for compatibility; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep syntax behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LanguageGoalsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LanguageGoalsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LanguageGoalsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.01 and compatibility.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.01 Language goals and grammar boundary

Threading model: syntax

This page defines the threading model for Language goals and grammar boundary, with particular attention to syntax. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Syntax is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with types is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for syntax; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep types behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Language", "LanguageGoalsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.01 and syntax.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.01 Language goals and grammar boundary

Memory strategy: types

This page defines the memory strategy for Language goals and grammar boundary, with particular attention to types. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Types is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with modules is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for types; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep modules behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LanguageGoalsAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LanguageGoalsAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LanguageGoalsAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.01 and types.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.01 Language goals and grammar boundary

Failure handling: modules

This page defines the failure handling for Language goals and grammar boundary, with particular attention to modules. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Modules is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with small-language rule is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for modules; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep small-language rule behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Language", "LanguageGoalsAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.01 and modules.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.02 Lexer and parser

Purpose and boundary: tokens

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Lexer and parser, with particular attention to tokens. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Tokens is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with AST is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for tokens; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep AST behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LexerAndParserService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LexerAndParserConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LexerAndParserState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.02 and tokens.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.02 Lexer and parser

Architecture: AST

This page defines the architecture for Lexer and parser, with particular attention to AST. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Ast is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with error recovery is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for AST; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep error recovery behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Lexer", "LexerAndParser");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.02 and AST.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.02 Lexer and parser

Data model: error recovery

This page defines the data model for Lexer and parser, with particular attention to error recovery. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Error recovery is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with source maps is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for error recovery; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep source maps behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LexerAndParserService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LexerAndParserConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LexerAndParserState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.02 and error recovery.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.02 Lexer and parser

Public API: source maps

This page defines the public api for Lexer and parser, with particular attention to source maps. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Source maps is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with tests is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for source maps; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep tests behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Lexer", "LexerAndParser");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.02 and source maps.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.02 Lexer and parser

Ownership and lifetime: tests

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Lexer and parser, with particular attention to tests. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Tests is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with tokens is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for tests; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep tokens behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LexerAndParserService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LexerAndParserConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LexerAndParserState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.02 and tests.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.02 Lexer and parser

Threading model: tokens

This page defines the threading model for Lexer and parser, with particular attention to tokens. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Tokens is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with AST is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for tokens; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep AST behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Lexer", "LexerAndParser");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.02 and tokens.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.02 Lexer and parser

Memory strategy: AST

This page defines the memory strategy for Lexer and parser, with particular attention to AST. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Ast is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with error recovery is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for AST; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep error recovery behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LexerAndParserService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LexerAndParserConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LexerAndParserState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.02 and AST.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.02 Lexer and parser

Failure handling: error recovery

This page defines the failure handling for Lexer and parser, with particular attention to error recovery. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Error recovery is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with source maps is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for error recovery; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep source maps behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Lexer", "LexerAndParser");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.02 and error recovery.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.02 Lexer and parser

Diagnostics: source maps

This page defines the diagnostics for Lexer and parser, with particular attention to source maps. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Source maps is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with tests is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for source maps; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep tests behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LexerAndParserService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LexerAndParserConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LexerAndParserState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.02 and source maps.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.02 Lexer and parser

Implementation sequence: tests

This page defines the implementation sequence for Lexer and parser, with particular attention to tests. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Tests is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with tokens is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for tests; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep tokens behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Lexer", "LexerAndParser");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.02 and tests.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.02 Lexer and parser

Verification: tokens

This page defines the verification for Lexer and parser, with particular attention to tokens. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Tokens is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with AST is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for tokens; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep AST behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class LexerAndParserService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const LexerAndParserConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    LexerAndParserState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.02 and tokens.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.02 Lexer and parser

Completion gate: AST

This page defines the completion gate for Lexer and parser, with particular attention to AST. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Ast is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with error recovery is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for AST; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep error recovery behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Lexer", "LexerAndParser");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.02 and AST.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.03 Semantic analysis and type system

Purpose and boundary: symbols

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Semantic analysis and type system, with particular attention to symbols. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Symbols is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with overloads is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for symbols; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep overloads behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SemanticAnalysisAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SemanticAnalysisAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SemanticAnalysisAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.03 and symbols.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.03 Semantic analysis and type system

Architecture: overloads

This page defines the architecture for Semantic analysis and type system, with particular attention to overloads. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Overloads is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with conversion is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for overloads; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep conversion behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Semantic", "SemanticAnalysisAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.03 and overloads.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.03 Semantic analysis and type system

Data model: conversion

This page defines the data model for Semantic analysis and type system, with particular attention to conversion. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Conversion is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with inheritance is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for conversion; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep inheritance behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SemanticAnalysisAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SemanticAnalysisAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SemanticAnalysisAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.03 and conversion.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.03 Semantic analysis and type system

Public API: inheritance

This page defines the public api for Semantic analysis and type system, with particular attention to inheritance. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Inheritance is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with diagnostics is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for inheritance; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep diagnostics behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Semantic", "SemanticAnalysisAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.03 and inheritance.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.03 Semantic analysis and type system

Ownership and lifetime: diagnostics

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Semantic analysis and type system, with particular attention to diagnostics. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Diagnostics is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with symbols is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for diagnostics; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep symbols behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SemanticAnalysisAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SemanticAnalysisAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SemanticAnalysisAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.03 and diagnostics.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.03 Semantic analysis and type system

Threading model: symbols

This page defines the threading model for Semantic analysis and type system, with particular attention to symbols. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Symbols is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with overloads is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for symbols; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep overloads behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Semantic", "SemanticAnalysisAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.03 and symbols.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.03 Semantic analysis and type system

Memory strategy: overloads

This page defines the memory strategy for Semantic analysis and type system, with particular attention to overloads. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Overloads is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with conversion is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for overloads; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep conversion behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SemanticAnalysisAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SemanticAnalysisAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SemanticAnalysisAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.03 and overloads.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.03 Semantic analysis and type system

Failure handling: conversion

This page defines the failure handling for Semantic analysis and type system, with particular attention to conversion. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Conversion is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with inheritance is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for conversion; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep inheritance behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Semantic", "SemanticAnalysisAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.03 and conversion.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.03 Semantic analysis and type system

Diagnostics: inheritance

This page defines the diagnostics for Semantic analysis and type system, with particular attention to inheritance. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Inheritance is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with diagnostics is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for inheritance; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep diagnostics behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SemanticAnalysisAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SemanticAnalysisAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SemanticAnalysisAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.03 and inheritance.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.03 Semantic analysis and type system

Implementation sequence: diagnostics

This page defines the implementation sequence for Semantic analysis and type system, with particular attention to diagnostics. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Diagnostics is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with symbols is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for diagnostics; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep symbols behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Semantic", "SemanticAnalysisAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.03 and diagnostics.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.03 Semantic analysis and type system

Verification: symbols

This page defines the verification for Semantic analysis and type system, with particular attention to symbols. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Symbols is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with overloads is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for symbols; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep overloads behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SemanticAnalysisAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SemanticAnalysisAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SemanticAnalysisAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.03 and symbols.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.03 Semantic analysis and type system

Completion gate: overloads

This page defines the completion gate for Semantic analysis and type system, with particular attention to overloads. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Overloads is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with conversion is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for overloads; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep conversion behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Semantic", "SemanticAnalysisAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.03 and overloads.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.03 Semantic analysis and type system

Purpose and boundary: conversion

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Semantic analysis and type system, with particular attention to conversion. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Conversion is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with inheritance is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for conversion; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep inheritance behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SemanticAnalysisAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SemanticAnalysisAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SemanticAnalysisAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.03 and conversion.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.04 Bytecode format and verifier

Purpose and boundary: instructions

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Bytecode format and verifier, with particular attention to instructions. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Instructions is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with constants is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for instructions; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep constants behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class BytecodeFormatAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const BytecodeFormatAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    BytecodeFormatAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.04 and instructions.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.04 Bytecode format and verifier

Architecture: constants

This page defines the architecture for Bytecode format and verifier, with particular attention to constants. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Constants is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with versions is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for constants; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep versions behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Bytecode", "BytecodeFormatAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.04 and constants.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.04 Bytecode format and verifier

Data model: versions

This page defines the data model for Bytecode format and verifier, with particular attention to versions. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Versions is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with validation is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for versions; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep validation behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class BytecodeFormatAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const BytecodeFormatAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    BytecodeFormatAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.04 and versions.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.04 Bytecode format and verifier

Public API: validation

This page defines the public api for Bytecode format and verifier, with particular attention to validation. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Validation is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with disassembly is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for validation; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep disassembly behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Bytecode", "BytecodeFormatAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.04 and validation.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.04 Bytecode format and verifier

Ownership and lifetime: disassembly

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Bytecode format and verifier, with particular attention to disassembly. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Disassembly is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with instructions is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for disassembly; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep instructions behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class BytecodeFormatAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const BytecodeFormatAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    BytecodeFormatAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.04 and disassembly.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.04 Bytecode format and verifier

Threading model: instructions

This page defines the threading model for Bytecode format and verifier, with particular attention to instructions. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Instructions is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with constants is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for instructions; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep constants behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Bytecode", "BytecodeFormatAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.04 and instructions.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.04 Bytecode format and verifier

Memory strategy: constants

This page defines the memory strategy for Bytecode format and verifier, with particular attention to constants. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Constants is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with versions is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for constants; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep versions behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class BytecodeFormatAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const BytecodeFormatAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    BytecodeFormatAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.04 and constants.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.04 Bytecode format and verifier

Failure handling: versions

This page defines the failure handling for Bytecode format and verifier, with particular attention to versions. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Versions is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with validation is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for versions; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep validation behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Bytecode", "BytecodeFormatAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.04 and versions.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.04 Bytecode format and verifier

Diagnostics: validation

This page defines the diagnostics for Bytecode format and verifier, with particular attention to validation. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Validation is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with disassembly is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for validation; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep disassembly behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class BytecodeFormatAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const BytecodeFormatAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    BytecodeFormatAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.04 and validation.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.04 Bytecode format and verifier

Implementation sequence: disassembly

This page defines the implementation sequence for Bytecode format and verifier, with particular attention to disassembly. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Disassembly is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with instructions is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for disassembly; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep instructions behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Bytecode", "BytecodeFormatAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.04 and disassembly.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.04 Bytecode format and verifier

Verification: instructions

This page defines the verification for Bytecode format and verifier, with particular attention to instructions. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Instructions is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with constants is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for instructions; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep constants behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class BytecodeFormatAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const BytecodeFormatAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    BytecodeFormatAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.04 and instructions.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.04 Bytecode format and verifier

Completion gate: constants

This page defines the completion gate for Bytecode format and verifier, with particular attention to constants. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Constants is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with versions is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for constants; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep versions behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Bytecode", "BytecodeFormatAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.04 and constants.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Purpose and boundary: frames

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Virtual machine, with particular attention to frames. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Frames is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with calls is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for frames; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep calls behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VirtualMachineService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VirtualMachineConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VirtualMachineState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and frames.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Architecture: calls

This page defines the architecture for Virtual machine, with particular attention to calls. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Calls is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with exceptions/errors is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for calls; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep exceptions/errors behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Virtual", "VirtualMachine");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and calls.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Data model: exceptions/errors

This page defines the data model for Virtual machine, with particular attention to exceptions/errors. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Exceptions/errors is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with dispatch is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for exceptions/errors; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep dispatch behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VirtualMachineService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VirtualMachineConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VirtualMachineState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and exceptions/errors.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Public API: dispatch

This page defines the public api for Virtual machine, with particular attention to dispatch. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Dispatch is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with performance is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for dispatch; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep performance behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Virtual", "VirtualMachine");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and dispatch.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Ownership and lifetime: performance

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Virtual machine, with particular attention to performance. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Performance is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with frames is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for performance; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep frames behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VirtualMachineService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VirtualMachineConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VirtualMachineState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and performance.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Threading model: frames

This page defines the threading model for Virtual machine, with particular attention to frames. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Frames is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with calls is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for frames; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep calls behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Virtual", "VirtualMachine");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and frames.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Memory strategy: calls

This page defines the memory strategy for Virtual machine, with particular attention to calls. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Calls is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with exceptions/errors is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for calls; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep exceptions/errors behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VirtualMachineService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VirtualMachineConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VirtualMachineState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and calls.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Failure handling: exceptions/errors

This page defines the failure handling for Virtual machine, with particular attention to exceptions/errors. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Exceptions/errors is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with dispatch is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for exceptions/errors; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep dispatch behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Virtual", "VirtualMachine");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and exceptions/errors.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Diagnostics: dispatch

This page defines the diagnostics for Virtual machine, with particular attention to dispatch. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Dispatch is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with performance is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for dispatch; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep performance behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VirtualMachineService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VirtualMachineConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VirtualMachineState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and dispatch.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Implementation sequence: performance

This page defines the implementation sequence for Virtual machine, with particular attention to performance. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Performance is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with frames is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for performance; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep frames behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Virtual", "VirtualMachine");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and performance.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Verification: frames

This page defines the verification for Virtual machine, with particular attention to frames. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Frames is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with calls is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for frames; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep calls behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VirtualMachineService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VirtualMachineConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VirtualMachineState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and frames.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Completion gate: calls

This page defines the completion gate for Virtual machine, with particular attention to calls. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Calls is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with exceptions/errors is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for calls; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep exceptions/errors behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Virtual", "VirtualMachine");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and calls.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Purpose and boundary: exceptions/errors

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Virtual machine, with particular attention to exceptions/errors. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Exceptions/errors is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with dispatch is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for exceptions/errors; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep dispatch behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VirtualMachineService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VirtualMachineConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VirtualMachineState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and exceptions/errors.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Architecture: dispatch

This page defines the architecture for Virtual machine, with particular attention to dispatch. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Dispatch is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with performance is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for dispatch; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep performance behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Virtual", "VirtualMachine");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and dispatch.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.05 Virtual machine

Data model: performance

This page defines the data model for Virtual machine, with particular attention to performance. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Performance is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with frames is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for performance; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep frames behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class VirtualMachineService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const VirtualMachineConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    VirtualMachineState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.05 and performance.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.06 Managed lifetime model

Purpose and boundary: GC/reference counting decision

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Managed lifetime model, with particular attention to GC/reference counting decision. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Gc/reference counting decision is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with roots is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for GC/reference counting decision; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep roots behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ManagedLifetimeModelService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ManagedLifetimeModelConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ManagedLifetimeModelState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.06 and GC/reference counting decision.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.06 Managed lifetime model

Architecture: roots

This page defines the architecture for Managed lifetime model, with particular attention to roots. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Roots is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with native handles is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for roots; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep native handles behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Managed", "ManagedLifetimeModel");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.06 and roots.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.06 Managed lifetime model

Data model: native handles

This page defines the data model for Managed lifetime model, with particular attention to native handles. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Native handles is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cycles is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for native handles; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cycles behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ManagedLifetimeModelService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ManagedLifetimeModelConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ManagedLifetimeModelState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.06 and native handles.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.06 Managed lifetime model

Public API: cycles

This page defines the public api for Managed lifetime model, with particular attention to cycles. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Cycles is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with budgets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cycles; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep budgets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Managed", "ManagedLifetimeModel");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.06 and cycles.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.06 Managed lifetime model

Ownership and lifetime: budgets

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Managed lifetime model, with particular attention to budgets. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Budgets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with GC/reference counting decision is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for budgets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep GC/reference counting decision behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ManagedLifetimeModelService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ManagedLifetimeModelConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ManagedLifetimeModelState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.06 and budgets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.06 Managed lifetime model

Threading model: GC/reference counting decision

This page defines the threading model for Managed lifetime model, with particular attention to GC/reference counting decision. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Gc/reference counting decision is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with roots is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for GC/reference counting decision; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep roots behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Managed", "ManagedLifetimeModel");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.06 and GC/reference counting decision.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.06 Managed lifetime model

Memory strategy: roots

This page defines the memory strategy for Managed lifetime model, with particular attention to roots. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Roots is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with native handles is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for roots; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep native handles behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ManagedLifetimeModelService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ManagedLifetimeModelConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ManagedLifetimeModelState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.06 and roots.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.06 Managed lifetime model

Failure handling: native handles

This page defines the failure handling for Managed lifetime model, with particular attention to native handles. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Native handles is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cycles is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for native handles; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cycles behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Managed", "ManagedLifetimeModel");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.06 and native handles.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.06 Managed lifetime model

Diagnostics: cycles

This page defines the diagnostics for Managed lifetime model, with particular attention to cycles. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Cycles is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with budgets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cycles; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep budgets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ManagedLifetimeModelService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ManagedLifetimeModelConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ManagedLifetimeModelState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.06 and cycles.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.06 Managed lifetime model

Implementation sequence: budgets

This page defines the implementation sequence for Managed lifetime model, with particular attention to budgets. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Budgets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with GC/reference counting decision is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for budgets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep GC/reference counting decision behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Managed", "ManagedLifetimeModel");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.06 and budgets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.06 Managed lifetime model

Verification: GC/reference counting decision

This page defines the verification for Managed lifetime model, with particular attention to GC/reference counting decision. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Gc/reference counting decision is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with roots is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for GC/reference counting decision; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep roots behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class ManagedLifetimeModelService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const ManagedLifetimeModelConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    ManagedLifetimeModelState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.06 and GC/reference counting decision.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.06 Managed lifetime model

Completion gate: roots

This page defines the completion gate for Managed lifetime model, with particular attention to roots. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Roots is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with native handles is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for roots; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep native handles behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Managed", "ManagedLifetimeModel");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.06 and roots.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.07 Native C++ binding layer

Purpose and boundary: reflection bridge

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Native C++ binding layer, with particular attention to reflection bridge. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Reflection bridge is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with marshalling is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for reflection bridge; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep marshalling behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class NativeBindingLayerService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const NativeBindingLayerConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    NativeBindingLayerState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.07 and reflection bridge.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.07 Native C++ binding layer

Architecture: marshalling

This page defines the architecture for Native C++ binding layer, with particular attention to marshalling. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Marshalling is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with ownership is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for marshalling; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep ownership behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Native", "NativeBindingLayer");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.07 and marshalling.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.07 Native C++ binding layer

Data model: ownership

This page defines the data model for Native C++ binding layer, with particular attention to ownership. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Ownership is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with thread rules is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for ownership; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep thread rules behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class NativeBindingLayerService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const NativeBindingLayerConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    NativeBindingLayerState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.07 and ownership.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.07 Native C++ binding layer

Public API: thread rules

This page defines the public api for Native C++ binding layer, with particular attention to thread rules. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Thread rules is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with generated bindings is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for thread rules; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep generated bindings behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Native", "NativeBindingLayer");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.07 and thread rules.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.07 Native C++ binding layer

Ownership and lifetime: generated bindings

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Native C++ binding layer, with particular attention to generated bindings. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Generated bindings is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with reflection bridge is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for generated bindings; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep reflection bridge behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class NativeBindingLayerService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const NativeBindingLayerConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    NativeBindingLayerState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.07 and generated bindings.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.07 Native C++ binding layer

Threading model: reflection bridge

This page defines the threading model for Native C++ binding layer, with particular attention to reflection bridge. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Reflection bridge is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with marshalling is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for reflection bridge; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep marshalling behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Native", "NativeBindingLayer");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.07 and reflection bridge.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.07 Native C++ binding layer

Memory strategy: marshalling

This page defines the memory strategy for Native C++ binding layer, with particular attention to marshalling. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Marshalling is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with ownership is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for marshalling; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep ownership behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class NativeBindingLayerService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const NativeBindingLayerConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    NativeBindingLayerState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.07 and marshalling.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.07 Native C++ binding layer

Failure handling: ownership

This page defines the failure handling for Native C++ binding layer, with particular attention to ownership. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Ownership is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with thread rules is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for ownership; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep thread rules behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Native", "NativeBindingLayer");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.07 and ownership.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.07 Native C++ binding layer

Diagnostics: thread rules

This page defines the diagnostics for Native C++ binding layer, with particular attention to thread rules. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Thread rules is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with generated bindings is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for thread rules; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep generated bindings behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class NativeBindingLayerService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const NativeBindingLayerConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    NativeBindingLayerState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.07 and thread rules.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.07 Native C++ binding layer

Implementation sequence: generated bindings

This page defines the implementation sequence for Native C++ binding layer, with particular attention to generated bindings. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Generated bindings is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with reflection bridge is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for generated bindings; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep reflection bridge behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Native", "NativeBindingLayer");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.07 and generated bindings.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.07 Native C++ binding layer

Verification: reflection bridge

This page defines the verification for Native C++ binding layer, with particular attention to reflection bridge. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Reflection bridge is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with marshalling is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for reflection bridge; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep marshalling behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class NativeBindingLayerService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const NativeBindingLayerConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    NativeBindingLayerState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.07 and reflection bridge.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.07 Native C++ binding layer

Completion gate: marshalling

This page defines the completion gate for Native C++ binding layer, with particular attention to marshalling. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Marshalling is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with ownership is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for marshalling; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep ownership behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Native", "NativeBindingLayer");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.07 and marshalling.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.07 Native C++ binding layer

Purpose and boundary: ownership

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Native C++ binding layer, with particular attention to ownership. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Ownership is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with thread rules is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for ownership; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep thread rules behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class NativeBindingLayerService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const NativeBindingLayerConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    NativeBindingLayerState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.07 and ownership.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.08 Events, coroutines and tasks

Purpose and boundary: yielding

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Events, coroutines and tasks, with particular attention to yielding. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Yielding is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with engine jobs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for yielding; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep engine jobs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class EventsCoroutinesAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const EventsCoroutinesAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    EventsCoroutinesAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.08 and yielding.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.08 Events, coroutines and tasks

Architecture: engine jobs

This page defines the architecture for Events, coroutines and tasks, with particular attention to engine jobs. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Engine jobs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cancellation is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for engine jobs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cancellation behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Events", "EventsCoroutinesAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.08 and engine jobs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.08 Events, coroutines and tasks

Data model: cancellation

This page defines the data model for Events, coroutines and tasks, with particular attention to cancellation. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Cancellation is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with lifetime is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cancellation; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep lifetime behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class EventsCoroutinesAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const EventsCoroutinesAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    EventsCoroutinesAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.08 and cancellation.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.08 Events, coroutines and tasks

Public API: lifetime

This page defines the public api for Events, coroutines and tasks, with particular attention to lifetime. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Lifetime is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with debugging is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for lifetime; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep debugging behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Events", "EventsCoroutinesAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.08 and lifetime.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.08 Events, coroutines and tasks

Ownership and lifetime: debugging

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Events, coroutines and tasks, with particular attention to debugging. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Debugging is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with yielding is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for debugging; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep yielding behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class EventsCoroutinesAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const EventsCoroutinesAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    EventsCoroutinesAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.08 and debugging.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.08 Events, coroutines and tasks

Threading model: yielding

This page defines the threading model for Events, coroutines and tasks, with particular attention to yielding. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Yielding is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with engine jobs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for yielding; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep engine jobs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Events", "EventsCoroutinesAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.08 and yielding.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.08 Events, coroutines and tasks

Memory strategy: engine jobs

This page defines the memory strategy for Events, coroutines and tasks, with particular attention to engine jobs. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Engine jobs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cancellation is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for engine jobs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cancellation behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class EventsCoroutinesAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const EventsCoroutinesAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    EventsCoroutinesAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.08 and engine jobs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.08 Events, coroutines and tasks

Failure handling: cancellation

This page defines the failure handling for Events, coroutines and tasks, with particular attention to cancellation. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Cancellation is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with lifetime is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for cancellation; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep lifetime behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Events", "EventsCoroutinesAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.08 and cancellation.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.08 Events, coroutines and tasks

Diagnostics: lifetime

This page defines the diagnostics for Events, coroutines and tasks, with particular attention to lifetime. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Lifetime is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with debugging is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for lifetime; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep debugging behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class EventsCoroutinesAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const EventsCoroutinesAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    EventsCoroutinesAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.08 and lifetime.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.08 Events, coroutines and tasks

Implementation sequence: debugging

This page defines the implementation sequence for Events, coroutines and tasks, with particular attention to debugging. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Debugging is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with yielding is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for debugging; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep yielding behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Events", "EventsCoroutinesAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.08 and debugging.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.08 Events, coroutines and tasks

Verification: yielding

This page defines the verification for Events, coroutines and tasks, with particular attention to yielding. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Yielding is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with engine jobs is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for yielding; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep engine jobs behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class EventsCoroutinesAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const EventsCoroutinesAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    EventsCoroutinesAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.08 and yielding.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.08 Events, coroutines and tasks

Completion gate: engine jobs

This page defines the completion gate for Events, coroutines and tasks, with particular attention to engine jobs. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Engine jobs is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with cancellation is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for engine jobs; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep cancellation behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Events", "EventsCoroutinesAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.08 and engine jobs.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.09 Hot reload and state migration

Purpose and boundary: compile pipeline

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Hot reload and state migration, with particular attention to compile pipeline. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Compile pipeline is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with class replacement is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for compile pipeline; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep class replacement behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class HotReloadAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const HotReloadAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    HotReloadAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.09 and compile pipeline.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.09 Hot reload and state migration

Architecture: class replacement

This page defines the architecture for Hot reload and state migration, with particular attention to class replacement. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Class replacement is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with instance state is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for class replacement; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep instance state behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Hot", "HotReloadAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.09 and class replacement.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.09 Hot reload and state migration

Data model: instance state

This page defines the data model for Hot reload and state migration, with particular attention to instance state. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Instance state is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with failure rollback is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for instance state; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep failure rollback behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class HotReloadAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const HotReloadAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    HotReloadAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.09 and instance state.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.09 Hot reload and state migration

Public API: failure rollback

This page defines the public api for Hot reload and state migration, with particular attention to failure rollback. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Failure rollback is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with compile pipeline is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for failure rollback; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep compile pipeline behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Hot", "HotReloadAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.09 and failure rollback.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.09 Hot reload and state migration

Ownership and lifetime: compile pipeline

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Hot reload and state migration, with particular attention to compile pipeline. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Compile pipeline is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with class replacement is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for compile pipeline; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep class replacement behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class HotReloadAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const HotReloadAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    HotReloadAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.09 and compile pipeline.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.09 Hot reload and state migration

Threading model: class replacement

This page defines the threading model for Hot reload and state migration, with particular attention to class replacement. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Class replacement is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with instance state is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for class replacement; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep instance state behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Hot", "HotReloadAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.09 and class replacement.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.09 Hot reload and state migration

Memory strategy: instance state

This page defines the memory strategy for Hot reload and state migration, with particular attention to instance state. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Instance state is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with failure rollback is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for instance state; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep failure rollback behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class HotReloadAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const HotReloadAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    HotReloadAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.09 and instance state.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.09 Hot reload and state migration

Failure handling: failure rollback

This page defines the failure handling for Hot reload and state migration, with particular attention to failure rollback. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Failure rollback is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with compile pipeline is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for failure rollback; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep compile pipeline behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Hot", "HotReloadAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.09 and failure rollback.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.09 Hot reload and state migration

Diagnostics: compile pipeline

This page defines the diagnostics for Hot reload and state migration, with particular attention to compile pipeline. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Compile pipeline is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with class replacement is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for compile pipeline; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep class replacement behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class HotReloadAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const HotReloadAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    HotReloadAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.09 and compile pipeline.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.09 Hot reload and state migration

Implementation sequence: class replacement

This page defines the implementation sequence for Hot reload and state migration, with particular attention to class replacement. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Class replacement is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with instance state is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for class replacement; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep instance state behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Hot", "HotReloadAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.09 and class replacement.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.10 SkeinScript debugger and editor services

Purpose and boundary: breakpoints

This page defines the purpose and boundary for SkeinScript debugger and editor services, with particular attention to breakpoints. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Breakpoints is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with stepping is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for breakpoints; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep stepping behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SkeinScriptDebuggerAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SkeinScriptDebuggerAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SkeinScriptDebuggerAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.10 and breakpoints.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.10 SkeinScript debugger and editor services

Architecture: stepping

This page defines the architecture for SkeinScript debugger and editor services, with particular attention to stepping. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Stepping is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with inspection is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for stepping; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep inspection behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Skeinscript", "SkeinscriptDebuggerAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.10 and stepping.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.10 SkeinScript debugger and editor services

Data model: inspection

This page defines the data model for SkeinScript debugger and editor services, with particular attention to inspection. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Inspection is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with autocomplete is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for inspection; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep autocomplete behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SkeinScriptDebuggerAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SkeinScriptDebuggerAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SkeinScriptDebuggerAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.10 and inspection.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.10 SkeinScript debugger and editor services

Public API: autocomplete

This page defines the public api for SkeinScript debugger and editor services, with particular attention to autocomplete. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Autocomplete is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with documentation is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for autocomplete; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep documentation behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Skeinscript", "SkeinscriptDebuggerAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.10 and autocomplete.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.10 SkeinScript debugger and editor services

Ownership and lifetime: documentation

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for SkeinScript debugger and editor services, with particular attention to documentation. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Documentation is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with breakpoints is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for documentation; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep breakpoints behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SkeinScriptDebuggerAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SkeinScriptDebuggerAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SkeinScriptDebuggerAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.10 and documentation.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.10 SkeinScript debugger and editor services

Threading model: breakpoints

This page defines the threading model for SkeinScript debugger and editor services, with particular attention to breakpoints. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Breakpoints is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with stepping is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for breakpoints; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep stepping behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Skeinscript", "SkeinscriptDebuggerAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.10 and breakpoints.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.10 SkeinScript debugger and editor services

Memory strategy: stepping

This page defines the memory strategy for SkeinScript debugger and editor services, with particular attention to stepping. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Stepping is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with inspection is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for stepping; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep inspection behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SkeinScriptDebuggerAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SkeinScriptDebuggerAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SkeinScriptDebuggerAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.10 and stepping.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.10 SkeinScript debugger and editor services

Failure handling: inspection

This page defines the failure handling for SkeinScript debugger and editor services, with particular attention to inspection. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Inspection is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with autocomplete is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for inspection; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep autocomplete behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Skeinscript", "SkeinscriptDebuggerAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.10 and inspection.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.10 SkeinScript debugger and editor services

Diagnostics: autocomplete

This page defines the diagnostics for SkeinScript debugger and editor services, with particular attention to autocomplete. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Autocomplete is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with documentation is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for autocomplete; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep documentation behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SkeinScriptDebuggerAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SkeinScriptDebuggerAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SkeinScriptDebuggerAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.10 and autocomplete.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.10 SkeinScript debugger and editor services

Implementation sequence: documentation

This page defines the implementation sequence for SkeinScript debugger and editor services, with particular attention to documentation. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Documentation is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with breakpoints is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for documentation; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep breakpoints behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Skeinscript", "SkeinscriptDebuggerAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.10 and documentation.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.10 SkeinScript debugger and editor services

Verification: breakpoints

This page defines the verification for SkeinScript debugger and editor services, with particular attention to breakpoints. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines unit, integration, stress, performance, and cross-compiler evidence.

Breakpoints is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to establish its inputs, validate state transitions, and bound failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with stepping is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for breakpoints; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep stepping behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class SkeinScriptDebuggerAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const SkeinScriptDebuggerAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    SkeinScriptDebuggerAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.10 and breakpoints.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.10 SkeinScript debugger and editor services

Completion gate: stepping

This page defines the completion gate for SkeinScript debugger and editor services, with particular attention to stepping. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract lists the objective criteria that permit dependent chapters to begin.

Stepping is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to enforce its inputs, isolate state transitions, and expose failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with inspection is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for stepping; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep inspection behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Skeinscript", "SkeinscriptDebuggerAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.10 and stepping.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.11 Plugin manifest and packaging

Purpose and boundary: identity

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Plugin manifest and packaging, with particular attention to identity. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Identity is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with version is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for identity; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep version behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PluginManifestAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PluginManifestAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PluginManifestAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.11 and identity.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.11 Plugin manifest and packaging

Architecture: version

This page defines the architecture for Plugin manifest and packaging, with particular attention to version. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Version is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with dependencies is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for version; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep dependencies behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Plugin", "PluginManifestAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.11 and version.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.11 Plugin manifest and packaging

Data model: dependencies

This page defines the data model for Plugin manifest and packaging, with particular attention to dependencies. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Dependencies is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with content is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for dependencies; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep content behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PluginManifestAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PluginManifestAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PluginManifestAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.11 and dependencies.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.11 Plugin manifest and packaging

Public API: content

This page defines the public api for Plugin manifest and packaging, with particular attention to content. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Content is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with platforms is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for content; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep platforms behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Plugin", "PluginManifestAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.11 and content.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.11 Plugin manifest and packaging

Ownership and lifetime: platforms

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Plugin manifest and packaging, with particular attention to platforms. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Platforms is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with identity is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for platforms; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep identity behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PluginManifestAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PluginManifestAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PluginManifestAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.11 and platforms.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.11 Plugin manifest and packaging

Threading model: identity

This page defines the threading model for Plugin manifest and packaging, with particular attention to identity. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Identity is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with version is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for identity; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep version behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Plugin", "PluginManifestAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.11 and identity.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.11 Plugin manifest and packaging

Memory strategy: version

This page defines the memory strategy for Plugin manifest and packaging, with particular attention to version. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Version is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with dependencies is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for version; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep dependencies behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PluginManifestAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PluginManifestAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PluginManifestAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.11 and version.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.11 Plugin manifest and packaging

Failure handling: dependencies

This page defines the failure handling for Plugin manifest and packaging, with particular attention to dependencies. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Dependencies is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with content is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for dependencies; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep content behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Plugin", "PluginManifestAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.11 and dependencies.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.12 Plugin load/unload lifecycle

Purpose and boundary: phases

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Plugin load/unload lifecycle, with particular attention to phases. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Phases is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with registration is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for phases; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep registration behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PluginLoadUnloadService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PluginLoadUnloadConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PluginLoadUnloadState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.12 and phases.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.12 Plugin load/unload lifecycle

Architecture: registration

This page defines the architecture for Plugin load/unload lifecycle, with particular attention to registration. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Registration is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with safe unload is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for registration; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep safe unload behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Plugin", "PluginLoadUnload");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.12 and registration.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.12 Plugin load/unload lifecycle

Data model: safe unload

This page defines the data model for Plugin load/unload lifecycle, with particular attention to safe unload. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Safe unload is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with hot reload is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for safe unload; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep hot reload behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PluginLoadUnloadService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PluginLoadUnloadConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PluginLoadUnloadState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.12 and safe unload.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.12 Plugin load/unload lifecycle

Public API: hot reload

This page defines the public api for Plugin load/unload lifecycle, with particular attention to hot reload. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Hot reload is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with error containment is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for hot reload; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep error containment behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Plugin", "PluginLoadUnload");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.12 and hot reload.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.12 Plugin load/unload lifecycle

Ownership and lifetime: error containment

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Plugin load/unload lifecycle, with particular attention to error containment. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Error containment is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with phases is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for error containment; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep phases behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PluginLoadUnloadService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PluginLoadUnloadConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PluginLoadUnloadState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.12 and error containment.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.12 Plugin load/unload lifecycle

Threading model: phases

This page defines the threading model for Plugin load/unload lifecycle, with particular attention to phases. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Phases is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with registration is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for phases; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep registration behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Plugin", "PluginLoadUnload");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.12 and phases.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.12 Plugin load/unload lifecycle

Memory strategy: registration

This page defines the memory strategy for Plugin load/unload lifecycle, with particular attention to registration. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Registration is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with safe unload is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for registration; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep safe unload behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PluginLoadUnloadService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PluginLoadUnloadConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PluginLoadUnloadState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.12 and registration.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.12 Plugin load/unload lifecycle

Failure handling: safe unload

This page defines the failure handling for Plugin load/unload lifecycle, with particular attention to safe unload. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Safe unload is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with hot reload is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for safe unload; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep hot reload behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Plugin", "PluginLoadUnload");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.12 and safe unload.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.12 Plugin load/unload lifecycle

Diagnostics: hot reload

This page defines the diagnostics for Plugin load/unload lifecycle, with particular attention to hot reload. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Hot reload is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with error containment is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for hot reload; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep error containment behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PluginLoadUnloadService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PluginLoadUnloadConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PluginLoadUnloadState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.12 and hot reload.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.12 Plugin load/unload lifecycle

Implementation sequence: error containment

This page defines the implementation sequence for Plugin load/unload lifecycle, with particular attention to error containment. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract orders the work so each step produces a testable vertical slice without premature abstraction.

Error containment is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to document its inputs, record state transitions, and measure failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with phases is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for error containment; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep phases behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Plugin", "PluginLoadUnload");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.12 and error containment.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.13 Plugin extension surfaces

Purpose and boundary: components

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Plugin extension surfaces, with particular attention to components. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Components is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with assets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for components; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep assets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PluginExtensionSurfacesService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PluginExtensionSurfacesConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PluginExtensionSurfacesState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.13 and components.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.13 Plugin extension surfaces

Architecture: assets

This page defines the architecture for Plugin extension surfaces, with particular attention to assets. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Assets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with editor is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for assets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep editor behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Plugin", "PluginExtensionSurfaces");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.13 and assets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.13 Plugin extension surfaces

Data model: editor

This page defines the data model for Plugin extension surfaces, with particular attention to editor. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Editor is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with render passes is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for editor; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep render passes behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PluginExtensionSurfacesService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PluginExtensionSurfacesConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PluginExtensionSurfacesState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.13 and editor.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.13 Plugin extension surfaces

Public API: render passes

This page defines the public api for Plugin extension surfaces, with particular attention to render passes. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Render passes is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with script bindings is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for render passes; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep script bindings behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Plugin", "PluginExtensionSurfaces");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.13 and render passes.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.13 Plugin extension surfaces

Ownership and lifetime: script bindings

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Plugin extension surfaces, with particular attention to script bindings. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Script bindings is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with build steps is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for script bindings; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep build steps behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PluginExtensionSurfacesService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PluginExtensionSurfacesConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PluginExtensionSurfacesState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.13 and script bindings.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.13 Plugin extension surfaces

Threading model: build steps

This page defines the threading model for Plugin extension surfaces, with particular attention to build steps. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Build steps is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with components is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for build steps; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep components behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Plugin", "PluginExtensionSurfaces");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.13 and build steps.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.13 Plugin extension surfaces

Memory strategy: components

This page defines the memory strategy for Plugin extension surfaces, with particular attention to components. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Components is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with assets is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for components; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep assets behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class PluginExtensionSurfacesService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const PluginExtensionSurfacesConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    PluginExtensionSurfacesState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.13 and components.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.13 Plugin extension surfaces

Failure handling: assets

This page defines the failure handling for Plugin extension surfaces, with particular attention to assets. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Assets is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with editor is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for assets; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep editor behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Plugin", "PluginExtensionSurfaces");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.13 and assets.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.14 Compatibility, security and test gate

Purpose and boundary: API versioning

This page defines the purpose and boundary for Compatibility, security and test gate, with particular attention to API versioning. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines what the subsystem owns, what it deliberately excludes, and the observable contract consumed by dependent modules.

Api versioning is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to record its inputs, measure state transitions, and preserve failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with sandboxing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for API versioning; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep sandboxing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class CompatibilitySecurityAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const CompatibilitySecurityAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    CompatibilitySecurityAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.14 and API versioning.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.14 Compatibility, security and test gate

Architecture: sandboxing

This page defines the architecture for Compatibility, security and test gate, with particular attention to sandboxing. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract maps responsibilities into modules, services, data flows, and explicit dependency edges.

Sandboxing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to validate its inputs, bound state transitions, and reject failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with fuzzing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for sandboxing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep fuzzing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Compatibility", "CompatibilitySecurityAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.14 and sandboxing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.14 Compatibility, security and test gate

Data model: fuzzing

This page defines the data model for Compatibility, security and test gate, with particular attention to fuzzing. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract specifies the stable types, identifiers, descriptors, records, and state transitions required by the implementation.

Fuzzing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to isolate its inputs, expose state transitions, and instrument failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with plugin matrix is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for fuzzing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep plugin matrix behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class CompatibilitySecurityAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const CompatibilitySecurityAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    CompatibilitySecurityAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.14 and fuzzing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.14 Compatibility, security and test gate

Public API: plugin matrix

This page defines the public api for Compatibility, security and test gate, with particular attention to plugin matrix. The implementation must be testable, cache-conscious, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines caller-visible functions, result semantics, invariants, and versioning expectations.

Plugin matrix is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to measure its inputs, preserve state transitions, and document failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with performance is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for plugin matrix; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep performance behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Compatibility", "CompatibilitySecurityAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.14 and plugin matrix.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.14 Compatibility, security and test gate

Ownership and lifetime: performance

This page defines the ownership and lifetime for Compatibility, security and test gate, with particular attention to performance. The implementation must be recoverable, deterministic, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract assigns creation, retention, transfer, invalidation, and destruction responsibilities.

Performance is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to bound its inputs, reject state transitions, and establish failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with API versioning is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for performance; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep API versioning behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class CompatibilitySecurityAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const CompatibilitySecurityAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    CompatibilitySecurityAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.14 and performance.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.14 Compatibility, security and test gate

Threading model: API versioning

This page defines the threading model for Compatibility, security and test gate, with particular attention to API versioning. The implementation must be plugin-safe, versioned, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines thread affinity, parallel work, synchronization points, cancellation, and shutdown behavior.

Api versioning is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to expose its inputs, instrument state transitions, and enforce failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with sandboxing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for API versioning; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep sandboxing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Compatibility", "CompatibilitySecurityAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.14 and API versioning.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.14 Compatibility, security and test gate

Memory strategy: sandboxing

This page defines the memory strategy for Compatibility, security and test gate, with particular attention to sandboxing. The implementation must be explicit, allocation-aware, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract sets allocation domains, budgets, transient storage, pooling, and diagnostic tags.

Sandboxing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to preserve its inputs, document state transitions, and record failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with fuzzing is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for sandboxing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep fuzzing behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class CompatibilitySecurityAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const CompatibilitySecurityAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    CompatibilitySecurityAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.14 and sandboxing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.14 Compatibility, security and test gate

Failure handling: fuzzing

This page defines the failure handling for Compatibility, security and test gate, with particular attention to fuzzing. The implementation must be thread-safe, portable, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract defines validation, recoverable errors, fatal conditions, rollback, and degraded operation.

Fuzzing is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to reject its inputs, establish state transitions, and validate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with plugin matrix is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for fuzzing; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep plugin matrix behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
SKEIN_TRACE_SCOPE("Compatibility", "CompatibilitySecurityAnd");
SKEIN_ASSERT(IsOnExpectedThread());
auto result = Validate(description);
if (!result)
    return Unexpected(result.Error());
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.14 and fuzzing.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.

08.14 Compatibility, security and test gate

Diagnostics: plugin matrix

This page defines the diagnostics for Compatibility, security and test gate, with particular attention to plugin matrix. The implementation must be diagnosable, bounded, and independently verifiable under MSVC and clang-cl. The contract identifies logs, counters, trace events, debug views, and evidence needed to understand behavior.

Plugin matrix is treated as an owned engineering concern rather than an incidental detail. The chapter requires the implementation to instrument its inputs, enforce state transitions, and isolate failure evidence. No caller may depend on private storage layout, backend-specific handles, undocumented thread behavior, or allocator side effects.

The primary interaction with performance is expressed through stable descriptors and handles. Dependent modules consume immutable descriptions or narrow service interfaces; they do not reach into internal containers. All externally visible identifiers remain valid only for their documented generation and lifetime, and stale references must fail predictably in development builds.

Implementation work should begin with the smallest executable path that proves the contract: configuration, construction, one successful operation, one deliberate failure, shutdown, and retained diagnostics. Optimizations follow only after the baseline is covered by tests and SkeinTrace markers. Performance changes must preserve behavior and include before/after evidence.

DESIGN OBLIGATIONS

- Define the normative contract for plugin matrix; distinguish required behavior from illustrative implementation detail.
- Keep performance behind SKEIN-owned interfaces so third-party or platform code cannot leak into callers.
- Assign each mutable field to one owning thread or protect it with a documented synchronization primitive.
- Tag persistent, transient, frame, and scratch allocations separately; expose budgets through diagnostics.

```
class CompatibilitySecurityAndService final
{
public:
    [[nodiscard]] Result<void> Initialise(const CompatibilitySecurityAndConfig& config);
    void Tick(const FrameContext& frame);
    void Shutdown() noexcept;
private:
    CompatibilitySecurityAndState m_state{};
};
```

REQUIRED EVIDENCE

- A focused test named for 08.14 and plugin matrix.
- SkeinTrace events showing startup, operation, failure, and shutdown.
- Allocation and thread-affinity assertions enabled in Debug.
- Build and test results for msvc-debug, msvc-release, clang-debug, and clang-release.